

Paula De Francisco Pérez

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Dear Duolingo Hiring Team,

I'm applying for the Regional Marketing Manager, MENA role. Making a global brand famous in this region — through social, influencers, partnerships and sharp local positioning — is precisely what I do today. From Dubai, I lead brand and marketing for DoFreeze (Befit, Eurocake, Flair) across 50+ markets in GCC, MENA and beyond, translating global strategy into campaigns that genuinely resonate with the Arab consumer.

Your brief asks for someone who delivers buzz and growth with ideas rather than large budgets. I built our influencer marketing programme from zero to 25–50 creators per campaign — sourcing, briefing and negotiating directly — driving awareness, UGC and measurable sell-out on lean budgets. I unlocked strategic partnerships with the region's most powerful consumer platforms (Noon, Talabat, Careem, Deliveroo) to give our brands scale and cultural relevance, and I run paid acquisition on Meta and Google with rigorous ROI/ROAS analysis. Earlier, at Alibaba's Miravia and at Glovo, I grew consumer marketplaces and apps — including leading a fragrance category expansion built on the region's leading Arabian and oud houses (Arabian Oud, Lattafa, Swiss Arabian, Ajmal), which gave me a deep, practical read on what Arab consumers love and buy.

Two more things make this a natural fit. First, I bring a founder's mindset backed by AI: I built a generative-AI marketing automation system that handles campaign planning, content, research and KPI reporting — cutting manual workload ~40% — which feels right at home in Duolingo's experiment-driven, AI-forward culture. Second, I know how to operate as the local expert inside a globally distributed organisation: at Miravia I was the local market team partnering daily with a remote HQ, influencing effectively for local needs — exactly the working model of this role.

I'm already based in Dubai with a residence visa, fluent in English (Spanish native), and genuinely passionate about Duolingo's mission — I'm one of your half a billion learners. I'd love to discuss how I can help make the world's most popular language-learning app famous across MENA.

Thank you for your consideration.

Best regards,

Paula De Francisco Pérez

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